

INTRODUCTION



Finances are an important part of marriage. Unfortunately, mismanagement of money accounts for the majority of divorces in America today. That should make this problem a critical issue for most husbands and wives. But for some reason, that's not the case.

The average marriage that ends in divorce starts out just about like anybody else's. These couples have high expectations; they really love each other. Sadly, their inability to make good financial decisions leads them down the road to disaster.

Wouldn't it be great if, in America today, divorce were limited only to non-Christians? But unfortunately, it is not. In fact, the divorce rate for "church" families is within about 2 percent of the national average. That says something: most Christian couples are just as ignorant about finances as most non-Christian couples. Divorce, bankruptcy, and debt within the Christian community indicate that our priorities are mixed up and that we are omitting some vital training for our children.

The average young married couple tries to accumulate in about 3 years what should take them 30 years to accumulate. Consequently, what they do accumulate is an enormous amount of debt. As a result of the debt, they have financial pressures; and as a result of the financial pressures, they stop communicating. They cease to be companions and instead they become combatants. When they talk, it's about financial problems. They don't bother to read their Bibles anymore. It's hard to study the Bible when your mind is consumed with problems. They don't pray anymore, because it's hard to pray when your mind is consumed with problems. Allow me to illustrate:

A young couple that I'll call Bob and Sue met in college and married when Bob graduated. Sue came from a Christian home and Bob was saved through a campus ministry when he was a college freshman. After college, Bob went to work in a stock brokerage firm and began to do quite well. His first year